Fluffy flourless fernet chocolate cake

coffee whipped cream

CHUCK CRUZ

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Fernet, a digestif served after a meal. Sometimes served with coffee. Usually served after a long day of restaurant work. Pairs great with chocolate. Chocolate pairs great with cherries. Luxardo cherries, aka the best walk-in cooler treat. They're expensive but very good. Whipped cream always. And that's how we got here.

I wanted to do a flourless chocolate cake but didn't want it to be so dense, therefore I added whipped egg whites. I also wanted the top to deflate and create a nice textured cracking on top. So for people asking if this is a soufflé, i dont know.

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VIDEO

Recipe: makes (1) 9-inch springform pan

Ingredients:

Cake:

- 340 grams semi-sweet chocolate, chopped

- 55 grams unsalted butter
- 8 large eggs, separated
- 2 egg yolks
- 120 grams granulated sugar
- 4 Tbsp fernet branca
- 1 tsp kosher salt
- 2 tsp vanilla bean paste
- Confectionary sugar, for garnish
- Coffee whipped cream, for serving
- Luxardo cherries, for serving

1. Preheat oven to 350F. Butter a 9 inch springform pan and line with parchment.
2. Add about 2 inches of water to a sauce-pot and place over medium heat. Bring to a gentle simmer. This will be for a double boiler situation.
3. Add chocolate and butter to a medium bowl (that fits on the top of the sauce pot of simmering water, without the bottom of the bowl touching the water.)
4. Place chocolate and butter bowl over the barely simmering water and let melt.
5. Meanwhile, add all the egg yolks, sugar, fernet, salt and vanilla bean paste to a large bowl. Whip with a hand mixer (or stand mixer) until fluffy, light yellow and thick, about 5 minutes. Set aside.
6. Once the chocolate in the double boiler has melted, stir to combine butter and chocolate. It will be thick. Immediately temper chocolate into egg yolk mixture by adding half of the chocolate mixture to the egg yolk mixture and whisking vigorously and continuously. It may look crazy at first but trust the process. Add remainder of chocolate mixture into the yolk mixture and whisk until combined and cohesive. Set aside.
7. Using a clean hand mixer (or stand mixer), whip egg whites to a medium peak. About 3-5 minutes.
8. Add half of the egg white mixture into the chocolate yolk mixture and gently

fold to combine. Add in the remainder of egg whites and fold until combined.

9. Pour cake batter into prepared pan. Place springform pan on top of a sheet tray.
10. Bake until middle is just barely set. About 35-45 minutes.
11. Allow to cool for at least 20 minutes. Sprinkle confectionary sugar on top.
12. Serve with whipped cream and luxardo cherries.

Whipped Cream:

- 1 cup heavy cream
- 1 tsp salt
- 2 Tbsp maple syrup
- 1/2 tsp espresso powder

1. Combine all ingredients in a bowl and whisk until desired whipped cream texture. I like a soft-ish whip.

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Courtny Nov 23, 2023

I've been making the same flourless chocolate cake recipe for years; excited to give this version a try!!

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